

ANTONIO DELLA PORTA

Ph.D. Student in Software Engineering for AI

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My background as a software engineer shapes how I do research: I want the AI we build to be reliable enough to use in real software, not just impressive in a demo. I study how we prompt large language models, whether the code they write is correct and safe, and how to get strong results from small, open models that anyone can run, not only the largest ones. My aim is to help make powerful, trustworthy AI something every team can build on, and to keep that future open and within reach.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Nov 2024 – Present

University of Salerno, Italy. Advisors: Fabio Palomba, Stefano Lambiase.

M.Sc. in Computer Science: Software Engineering and IT Management

2021 – 2023

University of Salerno, Italy. Final mark: 110/110 cum laude.

Thesis: *A Novel, Tool-Supported Inspection Procedure to Diagnose Community Smells through the Analysis of Dominant Behaviors* (Advisors: F. Palomba, S. Lambiase).

B.Sc. in Computer Science

2018 – 2021

University of Salerno, Italy. Final mark: 110/110 cum laude.

Thesis: *Quantum Computing: Funzionamento e Applicazioni di un Modello di Computazione Non Deterministico* (Advisor: A. Di Crescenzo).

EXPERIENCE

Visiting Researcher, Radboud University

Oct 2025 – Jan 2026

Department of Software Science, Nijmegen. Host: Mairieli Wessel.

Research Fellow, University of Salerno

Jan 2024 – Oct 2024

Project QualAI: Continuous Quality Assurance for AI Systems (Coordinator: F. Palomba).

Software Engineer, Minsait Italia

2021 – 2023

Delivered smart metering solutions, translating client requirements into tailored systems for efficient resource management.

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Papers

- [J1] **A Novel, Tool-Supported Catalog of Community Smell Symptoms.** Della Porta, A., Lambiase, S., Catolino, G., Ferrucci, F., Palomba, F. (2025). *Journal of Software Evolution and Process*.
- [J2] **Are Large Language Models Ready for Quantum Software Engineering? A Multivocal Literature Review** Della Porta, A., Lambiase, S., Catolino, G., Ferrucci, F., Palomba, F. (2025). *Under Revision at Empirical Software Engineering*
- [J3] **Understanding Prompt Quality and Its Relation to LLM-based Code Generation.** Della Porta, A., Lambiase, S., Pontillo, V., Ferreira, J. F., Rahman, A. A., Ragkhitwetsagul, C., Palomba, F. (2026). *Under major revision at IEEE Transactions on Software Engineering*.

Conference and Workshop Papers

- [C1] **TARS: A Theory-of-Mind Agent for Personalized In-IDE Code Comprehension.** Todisco, L., Della Porta, A., Lambiase, S., Palomba, F. (2026). *42nd Int. Conference on Software Maintenance and Evolution, Tool Demonstration and Data Showcase Track (ICSME)*, Benevento, Italy.
- [C2] **The Language of Security: How Prompt Syntax Shapes Secure Code Generation in Open LLMs.** Cicalese, M., Della Porta, A., Lambiase, S., Iannone, E., Hinrichs, T., Scandariato, R., Palomba, F. (2026). *42nd Int. Conference on Software Maintenance and Evolution (ICSME)*, Benevento, Italy.
- [C3] **Rebuilding AI from the Small: The Path Toward Democratized Intelligence.** Della Porta, A. (2026). *Int. Conference on Software Engineering, Doctoral Symposium (ICSE)*, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.
- [C4] **Ask, Then Think: Enhancing LLM Performance with Socratic Reasoning.** Della Porta, A., Richards, J., Cammarota, L., Lambiase, S., Palomba, F., Wessel, M. (2026). *23rd Int. Conference on Mining Software Repositories, Registered Report Track (MSR)*, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.

- [C5] **Toward Measuring Prompt Quality: A Preliminary Investigation on Prompt Smells.** Della Porta, A., Voria, G., Abbate, A., Sulipano, R., Lambiase, S., Catolino, G., Palomba, F. *3rd Workshop on Software Quality Assurance for AI (SQA4AI)*, Limassol, Cyprus.
- [C6] **An Evidence-Based Study on the Relationship of Software Engineering Practices on Code Smells in Python ML Projects.** Giordano, G., Della Porta, A., Ferrucci, F., Palomba, F. (2025). *51st EUROMICRO Conference on Software Engineering and Advanced Applications (SEAA)*, Salerno, Italy.
- [C7] **Teaching Software Engineering for Artificial Intelligence: An Experience Report.** Palomba, F., Voria, G., Parziale, A., Pentangelo, V., Della Porta, A., De Martino, V., Recupito, G., Giordano, G. (2025). *51st EUROMICRO Conference on Software Engineering and Advanced Applications (SEAA)*, Salerno, Italy.
- [C8] **Do Prompt Patterns Affect Code Quality? A First Empirical Assessment of ChatGPT-Generated Code.** Della Porta, A., Lambiase, S., Palomba, F. (2025). *Int. Conference on Evaluation and Assessment in Software Engineering (EASE)*, Istanbul, Turkey.
- [C9] **Unlocking Code Simplicity: The Role of Prompt Patterns in Managing LLM Code Complexity.** Della Porta, A., Recupito, G., Lambiase, S., Di Nucci, D., Palomba, F. (2025). *Workshop on Software Quality Assurance for AI (SQA4AI), co-located with SANER*, Montreal, Canada.
- [C10] **Transparent Machine Learning for Type 1 Diabetes Diagnosis from Gene Expression Data.** Carotenuto, R., Pentangelo, V., Della Porta, A., Palomba, F. (2025). *5th National Conference on Artificial Intelligence (Ital-IA)*, Trieste, Italy.
- [C11] **From Rules to Reports: Enhancing Diabetes Prediction Interpretability with Anchors and LLMs.** Festa, F., Della Porta, A., Pentangelo, V., Palomba, F. (2025). *5th National Conference on Artificial Intelligence (Ital-IA)*, Trieste, Italy.
- [C12] **Using Large Language Models to Support Software Engineering Documentation in Waterfall Life Cycles: Are We There Yet?** Della Porta, A., Recupito, G., De Martino, V., Catolino, G., Di Nucci, D., Palomba, F. (2024). *4th National Conference on Artificial Intelligence (Ital-IA)*, Naples, Italy.
- [C13] **Community Smell Detection and Refactoring in Slack: The CADOCs Project.** Voria, G., Pentangelo, V., Della Porta, A., Lambiase, S., Catolino, G., Palomba, F. (2022). *38th Int. Conference on Software Maintenance and Evolution (ICSME)*, Limassol, Cyprus.

AWARDS AND HONORS

Distinguished Reviewer Award, ICSE 2026 Shadow Program Committee 2025

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant, University of Salerno 2025 – 2026

Software Engineering (Prof. F. Ferrucci, Prof. F. Palomba) and Software Engineering for Artificial Intelligence (Prof. F. Palomba).
Delivered selected lectures and evaluated student projects.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Program Committee Member

International Conference on Software Engineering (ICSE'27)	2026
International Conference on Automated Software Engineering, Artifact Evaluation Track (ASE'26)	2026
International Symposium on Software Testing and Analysis, Artifact Evaluation Track (ISSTA'26)	2026
EUROMICRO SEAA, Measurement, Peopleware and Innovation Track (SEAA'26)	2026
Workshop on Empirical Studies for Quantum Software Engineering, 3rd ed. (E-QSE'26)	2026
Mining Software Repositories, Junior PC (MSR'26)	2025
TechDebt, Junior PC (TechDebt'26)	2025
AIware Datasets and Benchmarks Track (AIware'25)	2025
International Conference on Software Engineering, Shadow PC (ICSE'26)	2025
Workshop on Empirical Studies for Quantum Software Engineering, 1st ed. (E-QSE'24)	2024

Student Volunteer

International Conference on Software Maintenance and Evolution (ICSME'26)	2026
International Conference on Software Engineering (ICSE'26)	2026
EUROMICRO Conference on Software Engineering and Advanced Applications (SEAA'25)	2025
International Conference on Evaluation and Assessment in Software Engineering (EASE'24)	2024
International Summer School on Software Engineering (ISSSE'24)	2024